

Words Worth Eating



SEAFOOD LACED WITH CHEESE

"A scrumptious buffet dish!"

1 pound backfin crab meat
1 pound cooked shrimp
1/2 cup butter (1 stick)
1/2 cup flour
4 cups milk
1 teaspoon salt
1 6-ounce can sliced mushrooms,
drained

1 tablespoon minced celery leaves
or celery flakes
2-3 teaspoons chopped green
pepper
1/3 cup chopped green onions,
including tops

(over)

*1-2 teaspoons chopped pimento,
drained*

*4 cups grated sharp Cheddar
cheese, divided*

6-8 cups cooked rice

Gently pick through crab to remove all shell. Do not break apart lumps of crab. Melt butter in a saucepan over medium heat; stir in flour and allow to bubble for 2-3 minutes. Remove from heat and slowly stir in milk; return to heat and cook over medium heat, stirring constantly, until the sauce thickens to a medium-thick consistency. (Do not overcook.) Add next 6 ingredients and 3 cups of cheese. Cook over low heat until cheese melts. Remove from heat and gently fold in seafood. Pour mixture into a lightly greased 9 x 13 glass baking dish; top with remaining cheese. Bake in a preheated 350-degree oven for 30 minutes or until mixture is bubbly and cheese has melted. Serve over rice. Serves 10-12.

Note: This dish can be prepared 1 day ahead and refrigerated until ready to bake.

"A perfect buffet dish for elegant entertaining!"

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